

Practice Test 2

Section 1: Reading and Writing — Modules 1 and 2

54 Questions • 64 Minutes total (32 minutes per module) • Questions only

DIRECTIONS

The questions in this section address a number of important reading and writing skills. Each question includes one or more passages, which may include a table or graph. Read each passage and question carefully, and then choose the best answer to the question based on the passage(s).

All questions in this section are multiple-choice with four answer choices. Each question has a single best answer.

Reading and Writing

Module 1

27 Questions • 32 Minutes

1

The following text is adapted from Adela Trenholm's 1921 story "The Salt Line."

Letters came into the shipping office from Alexandria and Odessa, and Odile copied them without pausing over the names. Her employer praised her speed. Yet the ports themselves stayed _____ to her: she could not have said what any of them looked like.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical and precise word or phrase?

- A) crowded
- B) familiar
- C) abstract
- D) profitable

2

Printmaker Rewi Whitiora carves his blocks of Japanese mountain cherry with a shallow, rounded gouge and not the fine steel knife most of his contemporaries favor. The gouge leaves a wide channel, and ink creeps into that channel and prints past the intended edge. Where other printmakers' shapes end in a crisp line, Whitiora's _____ at the edges.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical and precise word or phrase?

- A) soften
- B) narrow
- C) vanish
- D) repeat

3

Istanbul's population more than doubled between 1980 and 2000, and demographers long assumed that villagers who moved to the city stayed for good. Household registration records — the state's own count — tell a more _____ story: nearly a third of those who registered in the 1990s had gone home within a decade. Many of them later moved yet again.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical and precise word or phrase?

- A) complicated
- B) gradual
- C) uniform
- D) familiar

4

Devised in 1928 by the poet Halldor Aasen, the braided stanza borrows the sestina's trick of repeating end words. Reviewing the first collection in the form, the critic Lucia Ferreira called it a dead end. She reached that judgment without hesitation, she wrote, yet she meant it to be _____ — a ruling in force only until other poets had attempted the form.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical and precise word or phrase?

- A) equivocal
- B) provisional
- C) tentative
- D) categorical

The following text is from Averil Meikle's 1911 short story "The River Stair," set in a Lancashire mill town.

For twelve years Elspeth had balanced the mill company's accounts, and the columns had always come out even by four o'clock. She could set down a figure without reading it twice. Lately she had begun to leave by the river stair and to stop at the rail above the weir until the light went. She only knew that the ledger, closed and squared on her desk, no longer looked like the end of anything.

Which choice best states the main purpose of the text?

- A) To describe in detail the bookkeeping procedures that a character follows at a milling company
- B) To explain why a character has decided to give up the position she has held
- C) To contrast a character's skill at her work with her growing difficulty in performing it
- D) To convey that a character's long-established daily routine has come to feel incomplete to her

Warlsen, an inland port on the lower Weser, was a busy grain market in the 1840s. A shelf of rock in the channel just above the town stopped seagoing ships from traveling any farther upstream. Cargo for the interior had to be unloaded at Warlsen and repacked into barges, and the brokers, warehouses, and insurers this work required settled there. Engineers blasted the shelf away in 1873, ships began passing Warlsen for mills inland, and by 1890 its warehouses stood empty. Warlsen's fortune, historian Nkechi Balewa concludes, had rested on an obstruction, not on anything the town produced.

Which choice best describes the function of the underlined sentence in the text as a whole?

- A) It states the conclusion the historian reaches about what made the town prosperous.
- B) It introduces a physical hazard that the text later identifies as the direct cause of the port's decline.
- C) It identifies the natural obstacle that the rest of the text treats as the basis of Warlsen's trade in grain.
- D) It supplies a detail about the channel that limits the claim made in the sentence before it.

Text 1

The seeds of the shrub *Corvalia hirtula* carry an oil-rich attachment — an elaiosome — that ants of the genus *Aphaenogaster* haul back to their nests. The ants eat the attachment and leave the seed intact in a refuse chamber underground. Botanist Njoroge Kamau attributes the plant's high seedling survival to this relocation: buried seeds are hidden from the ground-feeding birds that strip most uncarried seeds from the soil surface within days.

Text 2

Kamau's explanation cannot be the whole story. At sites where ground-feeding birds are absent, seeds carried into ant nests still produce far more surviving seedlings than seeds left on the surface do. The chambers are packed with discarded insect remains, and their soil holds several times the nitrogen of nearby soil. The advantage the ants confer, then, lies less in concealment than in the soil the seed lands in.

Based on the texts, both authors would most likely agree with which statement?

- A) Seeds that ants carry into their nests are more likely to produce surviving seedlings than seeds left on the soil surface.
- B) The oil-rich attachment on each seed is the main source of the nitrogen in the ants' refuse chambers.
- C) Ground-feeding birds remove most of the shrub's seeds from the surface before ants can carry them away.
- D) The nitrogen in the ants' refuse chambers is what accounts for the shrub's high seedling survival.

The following text is adapted from Marit Haugstad's 2015 memoir *The Long Thaw*, about two summers on her aunt's farm.

For two seasons my aunt let me do nothing but haul water and mend fence, and I resented the rusted knots. Then one June she stopped beside a stretch I had mended and asked why I had set those posts closer together. Without thinking I said the ground was soft and would not hold them. I had thought teaching meant being told things. Only then did I understand that the fence itself had been the lesson.

Which choice best states the main idea of the text?

- A) The narrator's aunt withheld instruction for two seasons in order to test the narrator's patience.
- B) The narrator comes to see that the chores she resented had themselves been her instruction.
- C) The narrator learns that fence posts must be set closer together where the ground is soft.
- D) The narrator's aunt avoided explaining her methods because she had never been taught them herself.

In the 1840s, textile workers in the mill villages of the Calder Valley began founding subscription libraries, small collections financed by weekly dues of a penny or two. The mills' owners had already provided reading rooms that charged nothing at all, but a manager selected every volume those rooms held, and workers who asked for titles outside his selection were refused. Historian Zerrin Balaban has concluded that the dues bought what the free rooms could not: the right to decide, by vote at their monthly meetings, what their shelves would hold.

According to the text, why did textile workers pay dues to libraries of their own?

- A) The reading rooms provided by the mills were open only to workers holding supervisory positions.
- B) The dues collected at the monthly meetings were used to support members during periods of unemployment.
- C) The mills' reading rooms held fewer volumes than the workers' subscription libraries were able to acquire.
- D) The subscription libraries allowed their members to choose the books the collections would contain.

Ornithologist Themba Ngwenya has spent five seasons putting up nest boxes for two woodland birds — the pied flycatcher and the great tit — that need cavities of the same size. If the two species compete for those boxes, occupancy by one should be low wherever occupancy by the other is high. The table shows the average percentage of boxes each species occupied per breeding season from 2019 through 2023 at four sites.

Nest-Box Occupancy at Four Woodland Sites, 2019–2023

Site	Boxes occupied by pied flycatchers (%)	Boxes occupied by great tits (%)
Forest of Dean	62	21
Wyre Forest	44	38
Elan Valley	29	55
Snowdonia	17	64

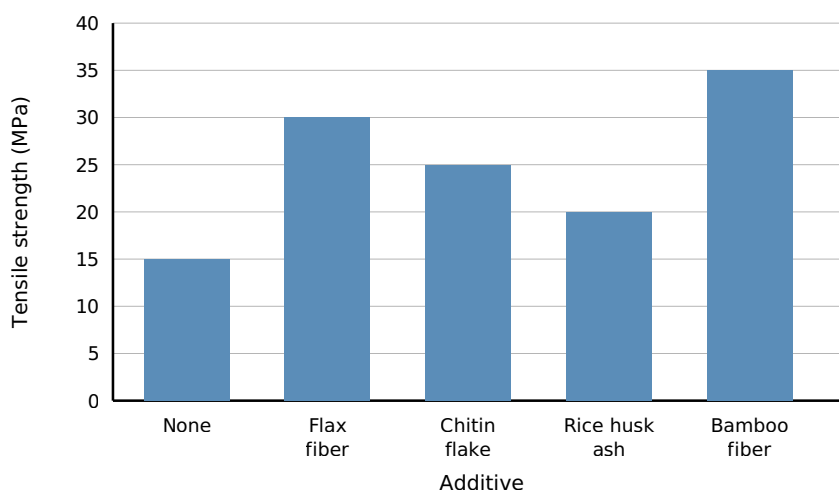
The pattern is most pronounced at the site where pied flycatchers occupied the fewest boxes: _____

Which choice most effectively uses data from the table to complete the statement?

- A) great tits occupied a larger share of the boxes in Snowdonia than in the Wyre Forest.
- B) in Snowdonia, pied flycatchers occupied 64 percent of boxes and great tits occupied 17 percent.
- C) in Snowdonia, pied flycatchers fledged more young per occupied box than great tits did.
- D) in Snowdonia, pied flycatchers occupied 17 percent of boxes and great tits occupied 64 percent.

Materials scientist Arvind Venkataraman works on starch-based bioplastics, which break down readily in soil but tear easily when the film is made from starch alone. His team measured the tensile strength, in megapascals (MPa), of a starch-only film and of four films each containing a different additive.

Tensile Strength of Starch Films by Additive



For the food-wrap application the team had in mind, a film must reach a tensile strength of at least 35 MPa. Of the four additives tested, only one produced a film that met this requirement: _____

Which choice most effectively uses data from the graph to complete the text?

- A) bamboo fiber, which produced a film with a tensile strength of 35 megapascals.
- B) flax fiber, which produced a film with a tensile strength of 35 megapascals.
- C) chitin flake, which produced a film stronger than the one made with flax fiber.
- D) rice husk ash, which produced a film stronger than the film made without any additive.

Larvae of the reef coral *Cladoporella tenuis* drift for days before settling permanently onto a hard surface. Marine biologist Nayeli Bustos and colleagues report that settlement happens almost exclusively on rock crusted with the coralline alga *Porolithon onkodes* — a species common on Indo-Pacific reefs — and they hypothesize that a soluble compound the alga releases into the water guides the larvae there. A competing account points to texture: crusted rock is rougher, and a rough surface gives a settling larva better purchase. The team is designing experiments to distinguish the two.

Which finding, if true, would most directly support the hypothesis of Bustos and colleagues?

- A) Larvae settled in large numbers on bare artificial tiles that had been roughened with a coarse abrasive and left in open water.
- B) Larvae settled on bare, smooth tiles when seawater that had held the alga was pumped over them.
- C) Larvae of a closely related coral also settle preferentially on rock crusted with *Porolithon onkodes*.
- D) Rock crusted with *Porolithon onkodes* holds more settled larvae than bare rock on the same reef does.

The Cinder Road is a 1922 novel by Honoria Merrow (1881–1955). Much of it is narrated by Miss Wrenford, a schoolteacher who boards with the Vantry family for a year and reports what she sees of the household. In an essay on the novel, a student contends that the narrator conveys her disapproval of Mr. Vantry not by criticizing him but by recording small acts of his that speak for themselves.

Which quotation from *The Cinder Road* most effectively illustrates the claim?

- A) "Mr. Vantry was, I am sorry to say, a mean man, and the whole village had long known it."
- B) "The ledger lay open on the sill, and beyond it the road ran white in the afternoon glare."
- C) "He rose before the others each morning and had the horses harnessed while the kitchen was still dark."
- D) "He counted the coins twice into the boy's hand, then took one back, remarking that lamp oil had risen."

In southwestern Ethiopia, where the starchy stem of the enset plant is a staple, nearly every adult sampled by microbiologist Zhanar Serikbay carried a gut bacterium of the genus *Prevotella*; almost no adult sampled elsewhere carried it. The bacterium is one of the few able to break down mannoglucan (a fiber that human enzymes cannot digest on their own). In laboratory mice, moreover, the bacterium disappeared from the gut within three weeks once mannoglucan was removed from the animals' food. Serikbay therefore concludes that the presence of the bacterium in an adult's gut _____

Which choice most logically completes the text?

- A) is likely to reflect that person's diet in childhood more than that person's diet now.
- B) is likely to make that person prefer foods made from enset to other sources of fiber.
- C) is likely to depend on that person's continuing to eat foods made from enset.
- D) indicates how much mannoglucan that person has consumed over the preceding three weeks.

Bogotá opened the TransMilenio busway in 2000, when most cities were still betting on rail. The network, which now moves more than a million riders a _____ its buses along lanes closed to other traffic and boards them from platforms set level with the doors.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) day runs
- B) day; runs
- C) day. Runs
- D) day, runs

16

When Basque arranger Iker Elorza scores a piece for a big band, he treats the horns as one instrument. The balance among the band's several sections _____ on how he voices each chord, from the lead trumpet down to the baritone saxophone.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) depend
- B) depending
- C) depends
- D) have depended

17

Medieval world maps were seldom drawn to scale, but the portolan charts Mediterranean pilots carried after 1300 were different — accurate, at least along the _____ fine lines, radiating from compass roses, let a navigator lay a straightedge between two ports and read off a bearing.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) coast, their
- B) coast their
- C) coast. Their
- D) coast — their

18

When historian Kwame Agyeman reached Kumasi in 1958, the brass casters he had come to study were no longer making goldweights. Gold dust _____ as currency across the Akan states for centuries before colonial coinage displaced it, and the weights went out of use with it.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) had circulated
- B) circulates
- C) will have circulated
- D) has circulated

19

Translator Zeynep Demirci met an old difficulty in rendering a Brazilian novel into Turkish. Its narrator speaks a rural dialect of Portuguese with no counterpart in Turkish, and Demirci settled on an unusual _____ a new idiom that belongs to no actual region at all.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) solution; inventing
- B) solution. Inventing
- C) solution: inventing
- D) solution, inventing:

20

Tall wooden buildings in Europe and North America were long limited to a few stories (rarely more than six), since ordinary lumber could not carry the weight of the floors above. Manufactured by gluing layers of lumber into panels that bear loads as well as concrete slabs do, _____

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) architects can now design wooden towers more than twenty stories tall.
- B) cross-laminated timber now lets architects design wooden towers more than twenty stories tall.
- C) building codes in several countries now permit wooden towers more than twenty stories tall.
- D) the design of wooden towers more than twenty stories tall is now feasible.

21

Most of the delegates who rewrote the state constitution in 1873 were lawyers or planters from the Mississippi lowlands. Three were not: Elias Vaught, a millwright from the Ouachita River _____ a printer who had set type for an abolitionist weekly; and Delia Ostrander, a schoolteacher from the Ozark counties.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) towns, Constance Barrow,
- B) towns; Constance Barrow,
- C) towns; Constance Barrow;
- D) towns Constance Barrow,

Across seventy North American cities (Montréal, Portland, and Minneapolis among them), transport researcher Kagiso Mokoena found that bicycle commuting tracks the length of protected lane per resident more closely than it tracks weather or terrain. _____ cities in the top quarter for lane length reported three times the commuting share of cities in the bottom quarter.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

- A) Specifically,
- B) In addition,
- C) Likewise,
- D) As a result,

In Lebanon's Beqaa Valley, making kishk (a fermented paste of cracked wheat and yogurt) occupies a household for most of a week. Anthropologist Rami Haddad found that the labor falls on one or two family members and that the paste spoils in humid weather. _____ every household he surveyed still prepared a full year's supply.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

- A) Consequently,
- B) Additionally,
- C) For instance,
- D) Nevertheless,

Materials scientist Sanna Virtanen's coating seals cracks as well as any self-healing polymer sold. Most such polymers repair themselves with embedded capsules that rupture along a crack and release a liquid adhesive, but Virtanen's coating contains no capsules. _____ its long molecular chains carry weak bonds that come apart under stress and reconnect once the stress is removed.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

- A) Moreover,
- B) Instead,
- C) However,
- D) In other words,

While researching a topic, a student has taken the following notes:

- Tsikhori and Nabadi are neighboring villages in Georgia's Racha highlands, known for painted house walls.
- Tsikhori murals show grape harvests in the village vineyards.
- Nabadi murals show shepherds driving flocks over a high pass.
- Painters in both villages grind pigments from local riverbed clay.
- Painters in both villages repaint the murals during a June festival.
- Ketevan Dolidze has recorded roughly 200 murals in the two villages since 2016.

The student wants to emphasize a similarity between the two mural traditions. Which choice most effectively uses relevant information from the notes to accomplish this goal?

- A)** Tsikhori murals show grape harvests in the village vineyards, whereas Nabadi murals show shepherds driving flocks over a high pass.
- B)** Although painters in both villages use local riverbed clay, Tsikhori murals depict harvests and Nabadi murals depict shepherds.
- C)** Painters in both Tsikhori and Nabadi grind pigments from local riverbed clay and repaint their murals each June.
- D)** Ketevan Dolidze has recorded roughly 200 painted house walls in the two villages.

While researching a topic, a student has taken the following notes:

- Ecologist Priya Ramanathan studies how traffic affects bird song.
- She recorded 400 male tailorbirds in twelve Bengaluru parks and in nearby forest.
- Traffic in the parks peaks between seven and nine each morning.
- Park birds began singing about forty minutes earlier than forest birds did.
- Park birds also repeated each phrase more often than forest birds did.
- Ramanathan concludes that the birds shift singing away from the busiest hours.

The student wants to present the study and its findings. Which choice most effectively uses relevant information from the notes to accomplish this goal?

- A)** Ramanathan recorded 400 male tailorbirds and found that park birds began singing forty minutes earlier than forest birds.
- B)** To learn how traffic affects bird song, Ramanathan recorded 400 male tailorbirds in twelve parks in Bengaluru.
- C)** Traffic in the Bengaluru parks that Ramanathan studied peaks between seven and nine each morning.
- D)** Ecologist Priya Ramanathan concludes that tailorbirds in Bengaluru's city parks shift their singing away from the busiest hours.

While researching a topic, a student has taken the following notes:

- Reflective displays form images by shifting pigment particles inside sealed capsules; they produce no light of their own.
- With no backlight, a device runs for weeks on one charge.
- Moving the particles into place takes about a quarter of a second.
- A backlit screen refreshes in a few thousandths of a second.
- Reflective displays therefore cannot show smooth video or animation.
- Engineer Baraka Mwangi is testing capsules whose particles shift faster.

The student wants to explain a disadvantage of reflective displays. Which choice most effectively uses relevant information from the notes to accomplish this goal?

- A)** Because reflective displays need no backlight, a device using one can run for weeks on a single charge.
- B)** Because moving the pigment particles takes about a quarter of a second, reflective displays cannot show smooth video.
- C)** Reflective displays form images by shifting tiny pigment particles inside sealed capsules rather than producing their own light.
- D)** Although reflective displays refresh slowly, engineer Baraka Mwangi is testing capsules whose particles shift into place faster.

— End of Module 1 —

Module 2

27 Questions • 32 Minutes

1

In the Sonoran Desert, few amphibians can store enough water to last a long dry season, so many survive it by becoming _____. Couch's spadefoot toad, for example, digs a chamber half a meter down, seals itself inside a shed layer of skin, and neither eats nor surfaces until the first heavy rain — sometimes ten months later.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical and precise word or phrase?

- A) nocturnal
- B) dormant
- C) migratory
- D) territorial

2

Solveig Halme wrote essays for a Helsinki weekly for two decades before any were collected. Critics now call them _____ because they refuse to announce a subject: a page on the price of coal becomes, with no transition, a page on a grandmother's hands, and the reader learns what the essay is about only in its final lines.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical and precise word or phrase?

- A) ornamental
- B) derivative
- C) sentimental
- D) elusive

3

The following text is from an original short story set in Lisbon in 1913.

Emilia had not come down to the harbor for the boats. She came for the _____: the shouted prices, the gulls, the ice sliding off the crates — a racket she had missed on each of the four years she spent teaching school inland.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical and precise word or phrase?

- A) commotion
- B) solitude
- C) scenery
- D) novelty

Statisticians distinguish two ways an estimate can fail. It may scatter widely, or it may be precise — tightly clustered from sample to sample — and still settle on the wrong value. A landline-only poll of Ohio voters fails in the second way: its figures barely vary, yet they miss the state total by the same wide margin each time. What it lacks is _____.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical and precise word or phrase?

- A) precision
- B) plausibility
- C) accuracy
- D) consistency

Finding one's way through a strange city (Venice, say) is usually described as a matter of building an internal map, a bird's-eye representation of how the streets connect. Psychologist Folarin Oyelude tested that description by leading volunteers along a winding route through an unfamiliar district, then asking them to point toward their starting place, a task an internal map would make easy. Most pointed poorly. When he showed them photographs taken along the same route, though, nearly all could name the next turn, which suggests that they had stored the route as a chain of decisions and not as a layout.

Which choice best describes the overall structure of the text?

- A) It describes a researcher's method, reports two findings that emerged from it, and then explains a widely held assumption.
- B) It contrasts two competing theories, evaluates the evidence for each, and endorses the better supported one.
- C) It examines how city residents remember streets, how they lose their way, and how they recover.
- D) It states a widely held assumption, reports a test whose results contradict it, and offers an alternative explanation.

Treatment technology can now purify municipal wastewater to a standard cleaner than many rivers cities already draw from. The obstacle to reuse in most cities, however, is no longer an engineering one. Surveyed residents in several districts accept recycled water for irrigation but not for drinking. Utilities in Namibia and California route purified water first through a reservoir or an aquifer, then withdraw it as ordinary source water. Engineer Arun Ilangovan notes that the detour (which removes no further contaminants) is meant to change how the water is perceived.

Which choice best describes the function of the underlined portion in the text as a whole?

- A) It reports the survey finding that residents accept recycled water for some uses but not others.
- B) It summarizes the text's overall argument that public perception now determines whether water reuse succeeds.
- C) It refutes the claim that recycled water fails to meet existing standards for drinking water.
- D) It shifts the text's focus from what treatment technology can do to a nontechnical obstacle.

Text 1

Bronze objects from the inland settlement of Anzir contain copper whose lead isotope ratios match those of Cypriot ores, three hundred kilometers away; no copper deposits lie near Anzir itself. Anzir's smiths were therefore importing their copper directly from Cyprus. The match is close enough to place the raw material in a single mining district on the island.

Text 2

Archaeologist Mariam Gelovani has shown that smiths in the region routinely remelted broken tools together with imported ingots, and that a workshop's stock could pass through several ports — and several owners — before reaching it. Isotope ratios record the ore a metal came from; they do not record the hands it passed through. Nothing in the Anzir material distinguishes copper carried from Cyprus by Anzir's own traders from copper obtained secondhand at any market between them.

Based on the texts, how would Mariam Gelovani (Text 2) most likely respond to the underlined claim in Text 1?

- A) By concluding that most of Anzir's copper was recycled scrap, not newly mined metal
- B) By observing that the claim depends on dating Anzir's bronzes far more precisely than the surviving evidence can possibly support
- C) By granting that the copper came from Cypriot ore but denying that its route to Anzir is established
- D) By rejecting the isotope measurements as too imprecise to link Anzir's bronzes to any ore source

The following text is from the 1931 short story "The Slow Hour" by Ingrid Vessmo. The narrator has just taken charge of the tower clock in her town on the Norwegian coast.

It had run four minutes behind since before I was born, and in a month I had set it right. No one thanked me. The baker asked why the bell now rang before his second batch was drawn; the ferryman said his boats were casting off half empty. What the town had learned, I saw, was not the hour but the clock's mistake, and it had built its mornings on that.

Which choice best states the main idea of the text?

- A) In correcting the clock, the narrator upsets the daily routines the town had quietly built around its error.
- B) The town's tower clock had run four minutes behind for many years.
- C) The baker and the ferryman had never learned to read the town's tower clock properly.
- D) The narrator restores the clock to its old setting once the complaints begin.

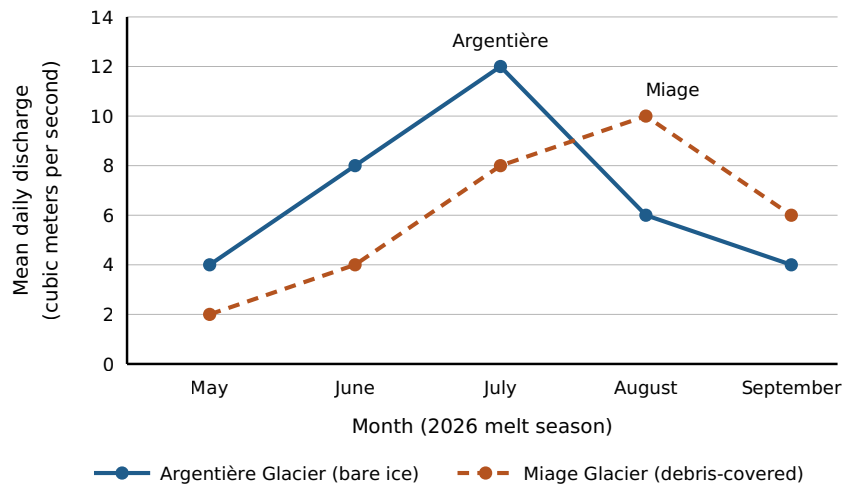
Fifteen panel paintings from the Bilbao workshop of Joana Etxeberri are sorted into two groups: an earlier one, whose drapery is dense and linear, and a later one, whose drapery is loose and broadly brushed. No document records the date of any of the fifteen, and the ordering rests on the stylistic difference alone. Conservation scientist Thabo Ramokgopa has now shown that panels from both groups contain the same yellow pigment, an unstable orpiment preparation (an arsenic compound) that the workshop's supplier made for only three years.

What does the text most strongly suggest about the two groups of panel paintings?

- A) They were painted decades apart, as the difference in their modeling has long been taken to show.
- B) The looser modeling of the later group shows that the workshop had begun to work more quickly.
- C) Panels in the earlier group were prepared by assistants and those in the later group by Etxeberri.
- D) They were probably painted within a few years of one another rather than decades apart.

Glaciologist Adil Mekouar gauges meltwater below two glaciers in the Mont Blanc massif: Miage, whose tongue lies under a thick blanket of rock debris, and Argentière, which is mostly bare ice. A glacier discharges most when its surface melts fastest, and he expects debris to shade the ice beneath it — so Miage should peak later in the summer than Argentière does. The graph shows mean daily discharge, in cubic meters per second, from May through September.

Mean Daily Meltwater Discharge at Two Glaciers, May Through September



His measurements match what he expected: _____

Which choice most effectively uses data from the graph to complete the text?

- A) Argentière Glacier discharged 4 cubic meters per second in both May and September.
- B) Miage Glacier's discharge peaked in August, whereas Argentière Glacier's peaked in July.
- C) Argentière Glacier's discharge peaked in August, whereas Miage Glacier's peaked in July.
- D) Miage Glacier's debris cover thickened over the summer, whereas Argentière's did not.

The verb "to flutter," meaning to rain lightly for a few minutes, was once heard on farms across the Yorkshire Dales. Sociolinguist Harpreet Grewal surveyed residents there in 2005 and again in 2020, asking respondents whether the verb belonged to their own everyday speech. The table gives, for each age group, the percentage who answered that it did.

Percentage of Respondents Reporting Use of the Verb "to flutter," 2005 and 2020

Age group (years)	2005 survey (%)	2020 survey (%)
18–29	36	9
30–44	52	41
45–59	64	57
60–74	73	69
75 and older	81	79

To Grewal, the pattern shows a word the community is giving up, not one people take up with age, and one age group is dropping it far faster than the rest: _____

Which choice most effectively uses data from the table to complete the statement?

- A) in both surveys, respondents aged 75 and older reported the highest use of any age group.
- B) respondents aged 18 to 29 went from 9 percent in 2005 to 36 percent in 2020.
- C) respondents aged 18 to 29 went from 36 percent in 2005 to 9 percent in 2020.
- D) respondents aged 18 to 29 were more likely to recognize the verb than to use it themselves.

"Low Field" is a 1929 poem by Vasanthi Chidambaram. Its speaker walks the boundary of a farm in the Nilgiri hills where she spent her childhood summers, naming the buildings, the animals, and the fields as she goes. Readers have often praised the poem for the exactness of its rural detail. A student contends that it is nonetheless not a record of settled memory: the speaker keeps revising her recollections in the very act of stating them, so that the reader watches the past being assembled and corrected.

Which quotation from "Low Field" most effectively illustrates the claim?

- A) "The gate was blue — no, the gate was green; I have put it here from another summer, I think."
- B) "What I remember of that place is uncertain, and I do not trust its order."
- C) "I remember the well, the three white hens, the loose board at the foot of the stair."
- D) "The low field runs down to the water and the reeds stand shoulder-high."

13

Larvae of the moth *Chilonoctis pallens* tunnel into sorghum stems and can ruin half a crop (more in a wet year). Growers in northern Ghana who plant strips of the legume *Tephrosia argentea* between their rows lose far less, and without pesticide. Entomologist Bashir Toure and colleagues hypothesize that the legume acts chemically, releasing a volatile compound into the air that turns an egg-laying female away from any plant carrying the scent. A competing account credits spacing alone: the strips break up the stand, so a searching female meets sorghum less often.

Which finding, if true, would most directly weaken the hypothesis of Toure and colleagues?

- A) Larvae hatching in plots that included the legume grew more slowly than larvae in plots without it.
- B) Moths laid their usual number of eggs on sorghum bathed in air piped from the legume.
- C) Plots that included strips of the legume received far fewer moth eggs than plots of sorghum alone.
- D) Sorghum plants at the center of a dense stand received fewer moth eggs than plants at its edge.

14

Behavioral economist Ines Salgado poured identical cups of pressed apple juice (all from one carton) for several groups of shoppers at a food fair in Valencia. Those told before tasting that the juice sold for nine euros a bottle rated its flavor higher than those told it sold for three. Among shoppers who tasted first and heard the price only afterward, the two prices produced ratings that did not differ. Salgado concludes that the effect of price on how a product is judged _____

Which choice most logically completes the text?

- A) proves that shoppers will always judge the more expensive version of a product to be better.
- B) is likely to depend on whether the price is known before the product is tasted.
- C) likely explains why producers of better-tasting juice can charge more than their competitors do.
- D) may indicate how much more shoppers would pay for the juice they rated as better tasting.

15

Many animals grow strikingly large in cold, deep water, a pattern biologists call deep-sea gigantism. The pale, slow-moving amphipods that scavenge on the floor of the Mariana Trench more than six kilometers below the _____ reach lengths of thirty centimeters, roughly ten times the size of their shallow-water relatives.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) surface
- B) surface,
- C) surface:
- D) surface —

16

The county records office in Carmarthenshire keeps the only surviving copy of an 1871 borough charter, a document too fragile to photocopy. Because the office lends deeds, plats, and council minutes to visiting researchers only on site, _____ collection of nineteenth-century petitions has never left the building.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) its
- B) it's
- C) their
- D) they're

17

Not every source of a dye is equally practical. The blue pigment in the leaves of woad is chemically identical to the pigment extracted from the tropical shrub *Indigofera*. _____ woad yields so little of the compound that whole fields of it were needed to color a single bolt of cloth.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) tinctoria but
- B) tinctoria: but
- C) tinctoria, but,
- D) tinctoria, but

18

Ceramicist Chidi Obiako fired unglazed jars in a pit of smoldering straw and compared them with sherds excavated from a settlement in southeastern Nigeria. He found that the soot-blackened surface on his jars _____ the surface of the sherds almost exactly.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) to match
- B) matched
- C) match
- D) matching

19

Between 1931 and 1948, the choreographer Devika Rele made nine short pieces for a solo dancer and a single drummer in Thanjavur. Dance historians most often revive the _____ Rele set to a cycle of harvest songs. The other eight are rarely staged today.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) one, that
- B) one; that
- C) one that
- D) one — that

20

City wards are drawn to divide a population evenly, and Philadelphia's grew crowded as streetcar lines pulled households outward. When a ward map goes decades without revision, _____ the city it was drawn to divide, however precise its lines look.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) they no longer represent
- B) these no longer represent
- C) it no longer represents
- D) this no longer represents

21

Rotterdam and other cities now build parks that are meant to be useless for part of the year. A sunken plaza in one neighborhood there sits well below the surrounding streets and fills _____ a calculated sacrifice that spares the shops, offices, and apartments on the blocks above it while the storm passes.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) with runoff during, heavy rain —
- B) with runoff during heavy rain —
- C) with runoff during heavy rain
- D) with runoff during heavy rain;

Astronomers sort asteroids into families whose members share an orbit and a common origin in a single shattered parent body. Each of the fragments in the Karin cluster, one of the youngest and most tightly grouped of these families, _____ a spectrum consistent with the same silicate-rich interior, a match that chance alone would be unlikely to produce.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) show
- B) were showing
- C) showing
- D) shows

Food scientist Kwesi Frimpong found that cocoa beans at the cool outer edge of a fermentation heap ferment far more slowly than those at its center — a problem on the estates of Ghana's Eastern Region, where chocolate flavor develops during fermentation, not during roasting. _____ growers there now turn their heaps, moving the outer beans toward the middle.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

- A) Accordingly,
- B) Additionally,
- C) Conversely,
- D) In fact,

Novels told entirely in letters have endured since the eighteenth century because, literary scholar Hae-won Sohn notes, the form solves problems other forms leave open. A letter supplies its own reason for existing; the writer must explain events the recipient did not witness. _____ letters can arrive out of order, letting a novelist withhold information without seeming to conceal it.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

- A) For instance,
- B) Even so,
- C) Furthermore,
- D) In short,

Seismologist Yasmine Belkacem watched waves from distant earthquakes cross a pocket of rock — forty kilometers across — beneath a plain in northern Algeria. The waves slowed there, an effect produced either by heat or by heavy cracking. They also lost energy there, an effect produced either by heat or by trapped water. _____ these effects are best explained by a body of unusually hot rock.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

- A) Therefore,
- B) That is,
- C) Similarly,
- D) Taken together,

While researching a topic, a student has taken the following notes:

- The norsan is a two-stringed bowed lute of the Altai foothills (eastern Kazakhstan).
- Its sound box is built from thin wooden staves bent into a curve.
- Most makers bend the staves over an open flame.
- Makers in the village of Katon-Karagay soak each stave in cold river water for six weeks.
- Luthier Saltanat Yermekova of Katon-Karagay learned the soaking method from her grandmother.
- Katon-Karagay sound boxes crack less often in dry weather.

The student wants to introduce the Tergen makers' method of shaping staves to an audience already familiar with the norsan. Which choice most effectively uses relevant information from the notes to accomplish this goal?

- A) Saltanat Yermekova, a luthier in the village of Katon-Karagay, learned the soaking method from her grandmother years ago.
- B) Katon-Karagay makers bend a norsan's staves by soaking them for six weeks in cold river water.
- C) Katon-Karagay makers soak the staves of the norsan, a two-stringed bowed lute, before bending them.
- D) Katon-Karagay makers, who soak each stave, produce sound boxes that crack less often.

While researching a topic, a student has taken the following notes:

- The tufted meadow-hen vanished from the Ouse Washes and the Somerset Levels in the 1970s.
- Both wetlands now host programs releasing captive-bred birds (hatched off site).
- Both programs fit each released bird with a numbered leg band.
- At the Ouse Washes, birds spend three weeks in open-topped pens before release.
- On the Somerset Levels, birds are carried onto the marsh and released the same day.
- Ecologist Luciana Bittencourt has monitored both wetlands since 2015.

The student wants to emphasize a difference between the release methods used at Redfen and those used at Longmoor. Which choice most effectively uses relevant information from the notes to accomplish this goal?

- A)** The Ouse Washes program holds its birds three weeks in open-topped pens, whereas the Somerset Levels program releases them on arrival.
- B)** Both programs release captive-bred meadow-hens and fit each one with a numbered leg band.
- C)** Though only the Ouse Washes pens its birds before release, both marshes have been monitored by the same ecologist since 2015.
- D)** On the Somerset Levels, captive-bred meadow-hens are carried onto the marsh and released the same day.

— End of Module 2 —